Dennis Blake

Software QA Automation Engineer / SDET

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SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 12+ years in web, API and mobile testing. I build test frameworks from scratch with Playwright, Cypress and Selenium, connect them to CI, and keep regression suites fast and stable. Most of my work has been on logistics, fintech and retail products, where I also set up test data, reporting and the QA process itself. In the last two years AI tools became part of the job: agents and prompt engineering for test generation and debugging. On top of the hands-on work I train engineers and help dev teams adopt automation.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Automation: Playwright, Cypress, Selenium, Selenide, Java, TypeScript, JavaScript, JUnit 5, Mocha, Chai, Cucumber, Gherkin, Page Object Model (POM)

API / Backend: Axios, REST Assured, Postman, Newman, Swagger, REST APIs, SOAP, Fiddler, Burp Suite

CI/CD / DevOps: Git, GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, Jenkins, CircleCI, Docker, Selenoid, Kubernetes, Allure

Mobile: Android SDK, ADB, Xcode, TestFlight, iOS, mobile test automation

Databases: SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, AWS Redshift, data validation, test data management

Testing: Functional, regression, smoke, E2E, sanity, UAT, exploratory, risk-based testing, root cause analysis

AI & Agents: AI test agents, prompt engineering, GitHub Copilot, LLM-assisted test generation, test data generation and failure analysis

Tools: Jira, Confluence, Zephyr, Xray, TestRail, Trello, JQL, JSON, HTML/CSS, XPath, Grafana, Prometheus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software QA Automation Engineer, Mitsubishi Logisnext Americas Inc, Grand Rapids, MI | Apr 2024 - Present

- Built a Playwright and TypeScript framework for the company's web apps, with a Page Object structure and runs in three browsers
- Custom Playwright fixtures handle authentication, API clients and test data setup, so tests start from a known state without copy-pasted beforeEach blocks
- API tests are written in TypeScript with Axios, separate from the UI suite but running in the same CI pipeline
- Eight applications moved from manual regression to automation. Regression time dropped 40%, and releases stopped waiting on QA
- E2E and API coverage grew by 25%. Fewer defects reach production now
- Set up CI/CD pipelines for smoke and regression suites. Manual execution time went down 30%, and smoke results after each build cut defect detection time by 15%
- Test maintenance takes about 30% less effort after I cleaned up the page objects, added retry logic and parallel runs, and removed the main sources of flakiness
- Playwright runs in Docker. For the corporate network I built containers with VPN access, so suites reach internal systems and still pass the company's compliance rules
- Tests pull and seed data straight from the database, so data-driven cases do not depend on manual setup
- Taught Playwright to colleagues from non-QA teams. They now write and maintain their own tests
- Test results are published as Allure reports after each run, and failures trigger Slack notifications to the team channel, so nobody has to dig through CI logs
- When tests fail, I dig into the root cause with the developers instead of just filing a ticket. Fixes land faster this way
- Use GitHub Copilot in day to day automation work, for test code, boilerplate and debugging failures. Routine tasks take noticeably less time with it

- Prompt engineering is part of my daily work: I write and refine prompts that generate test cases, test data and page objects, then review and fix the output before it enters the suite

Software QA Automation Engineer, SmarterX LLC, Boulder, CO | Jun 2023 - Feb 2024

- Maintained and extended Cypress and JavaScript frameworks. Manual testing effort fell by 35%
- API checks run through Postman and Newman collections in CI, with Swagger contracts used for request and response validation
- Wrote SQL for backend validation and for checking data consistency between services
- Cut test flakiness by 15%, mostly by fixing environment dependencies that made tests fail at random
- Connected test results to dashboards, so the team and stakeholders see the current state without asking QA
- Mentored junior QA engineers and reviewed their automation code
- Ran performance checks to see how the application behaves under load and reported the weak spots
- Set up short feedback loops between QA, developers and product, so critical issues got fixed the same day instead of waiting for the next sprint cycle

Senior Software QA Engineer, Trinetix LLC, Nashville, TN | May 2016 - May 2023

- Built Java and Selenium frameworks with BDD (Cucumber, Gherkin) for API and UI testing
- Automation took about 30% of routine work off the QA and IT teams. The company shipped more than 150 releases in this period
- Reworked the existing suites and test strategy. Execution time went down 25%
- Wrote risk-based test plans and traceability matrices, and owned backend and API validation on several projects
- Onboarded new QA engineers and coordinated testing across teams and environments during releases
- Ran security checks on the applications and flagged vulnerabilities before release
- Set up automated test data management, so test runs use fresh data and stay repeatable
- Kept business stakeholders in the loop on test progress and release risks, in plain language rather than test reports
- Helped the QA lead with test strategy and traceability matrices across projects

Software QA Engineer, Dell AppAssure Project, Softheme LLC | May 2013 - May 2016

- Functional, regression and backend testing for a backup and recovery product. Took part in 100+ releases
- Rewrote a large part of the test cases and tightened the test strategy. Better edge case coverage cut production defects by 10%
- Wrote scripts for database validation and backend checks, which raised test coverage by 25%
- Proposed more than 30 product improvements. Most were shipped and user-reported issues dropped
- Led UAT with customers before major releases and managed the test environments for integration testing
- Analyzed failed test cases and gave developers specific pointers, which cut bug resolution time by about 10%

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Economics

COMMUNITY PROJECTS

Built the iOS app Bible Quiz for a local church, with interactive learning for members (2015)